

IR-2025-1021

Unauthorized Information Modification and Deletion

Incident Ref: IR-2025-1021

Classification: Major Non-conformity

Impacted CIA Component: Integrity and Availability

1. Executive Summary

On October 21, 2025, an identified actor initiated unauthorized modification and deletion events across core institutional shared drives. The incident resulted in the destruction of academic records and the restructuring of the information hierarchy without authorization.

2. Technical Timeline and Observations

- **Vector:** Activity originated from two distinct IP addresses, including a sensitive external gateway.
- **Containment Phase (11:03 – 11:19 AM):** The actor executed mass "Trash" events targeting the "Teacher Drive" and "Pre Testing" repositories. Impacted files included .pdf, .docx, and .ppt academic materials.
- **Unauthorized Modification (11:14 – 11:18 AM):** Information integrity was compromised via unauthorized renaming and setting changes on core shared drives, including "Office of the Principal" and "Foreign Teachers."
- **Restructuring (11:19 – 11:27 AM):** A second phase involved the creation of new folder hierarchies and the unauthorized movement of existing data, representing a bypass of standard administrative workflows.

3. Root Cause Analysis (RCA)

- **Primary Failure: Annex A 8.2 (Privileged access rights).** The actor maintained excessive permissions that exceeded their operational requirements, allowing for mass deletion and setting overrides.
- **Secondary Failure: Annex A 8.15 (Logging and monitoring).** While logs were captured, no automated "Alerting" mechanism was in place to halt mass-deletion events in real-time.

4. Corrective Actions and Risk Treatment

- **Immediate Containment:** Account suspension and IP blocking. Restoration of data from Google Drive Trash/Backups to ensure **Availability**.

- **Long-term Corrective Action:** Implement **Annex A 5.18 (Access rights)**. Transition to a "View/Comment" default for all non-owner staff, requiring documented justification for "Editor" or "Manager" permissions.